

# PEACE IN THE MIDST OF THE STORM

Preacher: Pastor Simeon Abutu | June 19, 2026

## Introduction

We live in a time when trouble seems to be everywhere. Nations are troubled, families face challenges, economies fluctuate, and individuals battle various storms of life. Yet, as believers, we are not helpless, abandoned, or without hope. God has provided His peace for His children even in the midst of life's storms.

## Text — Psalm 20:1–2

### Psalm 20:1–2

*"The LORD hear thee in the day of trouble; the name of the God of Jacob defend thee; Send thee help from the sanctuary, and strengthen thee out of Zion."*

This passage acknowledges a reality that every believer must face: days of trouble will come. However, it also reveals God's provision in those difficult moments.

David did not say *if* trouble comes, but *when* trouble comes. The assurance is that God hears, defends, helps, and strengthens His people in times of adversity.

The God who delivered Jacob from countless difficulties is still able to defend His children today.

## The Reality of Trouble

### Job 14:1

*"Man that is born of a woman is of few days, and full of trouble."*

Job reminds us that trouble is part of the human experience. No one is exempt from challenges. Wealth does not eliminate trouble. Education does not eliminate trouble. Position and influence do not eliminate trouble.

The issue is not whether storms will come, but how we respond when they arrive. As Christians, our confidence is not that we will never face storms; our confidence is that God will be with us in every storm.

## Jesus in the Boat

One of the most powerful examples of peace in the midst of trouble is found when Jesus and His disciples were caught in a violent storm while crossing the sea.

- The waves were beating against the boat. The wind was fierce.
- Experienced fishermen feared for their lives.
- Yet Jesus was asleep.

**The disciples saw the storm. Jesus saw the Father.**

**The disciples focused on the waves. Jesus rested in divine assurance.**

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His presence in the boat was greater than the power of the storm. This teaches us that God's presence does not always prevent storms, but His presence guarantees victory through them.

## God Guarantees Peace in the Storm

The storm is not really the greatest problem. The real question is: **Is God with you in the storm?**

### Psalm 23:4

*"Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil: for thou art with me..."*

Notice that David did not say he would *avoid* the valley. He said he would *walk through* it. God's presence changes everything.

The presence of God turns fear into courage, confusion into clarity, weakness into strength, and storms into testimonies.

## Peace in the Midst of Trouble

### Philippians 4:7

*"And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus."*

God's peace is different from human peace:

- Human peace depends on favorable circumstances.
- God's peace remains even when circumstances are unfavorable.
- It is a peace that surpasses human reasoning.

People may wonder why you are calm when everything around you is falling apart. The answer is simple: the peace of God is guarding your heart and mind.

## The Name of the Lord Is Our Defense

### Proverbs 18:10

*"The name of the LORD is a strong tower: the righteous runneth into it, and is safe."*

In ancient times, strong towers were places of refuge during attacks. Likewise, God's name represents His power, authority, faithfulness, and covenant promises.

When trouble comes, the righteous run **to** God, not **away** from Him.

His name remains our refuge, defense, protection, and security.

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## Help from the Sanctuary

Psalm 20:2 declares: “Send thee help from the sanctuary, and strengthen thee out of Zion.” The sanctuary represents God’s presence.

Many battles cannot be won by human strength alone. Divine help is required. God specializes in helping the helpless, strengthening the weak, and lifting those who are cast down.

His help may come through His Word, through prayer, through fellow believers, or through supernatural intervention. Whatever the means, **God's help never arrives late.**

## Deliverance from Zion

### Obadiah 1:17

*"But upon mount Zion shall be deliverance, and there shall be holiness; and the house of Jacob shall possess their possessions."*

This verse reveals three blessings when believers remain connected to God:

1. **Deliverance** — God provides escape and victory over every attack of the enemy.
2. **Holiness** — God does not merely rescue us; He transforms us to reflect His character.
3. **Possession** — God restores what belongs to His people and enables them to walk in their inheritance.

## The World's Definition of Peace vs. God's Definition

Many people define peace as having enough money, food, comfort, and freedom from problems. But Scripture presents a higher reality.

### Romans 14:17

*"For the kingdom of God is not meat and drink; but righteousness, and peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost."*

Kingdom peace flows from:

- **Righteousness** — being in right standing with God.
- **Peace** — inner calm and confidence in God.
- **Joy** — supernatural gladness produced by the Holy Spirit.

**The world seeks peace externally. God produces peace internally.**

## Peace Is Part of Our Inheritance

### John 14:27

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*"Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, give I unto you."*

This is not ordinary peace. It is the peace that sustained Jesus during opposition, persecution, rejection, and even the Cross. It is the peace that the world cannot understand and cannot take away.

## Conclusion

There is much more that can be said on this subject, but time will not permit us. One truth remains certain:

**We must never allow trouble to define us.**

Storms may arise, but we should hold our heads high, knowing that God is in our midst. Understanding God's peace gives us the right perspective — to see life as Jesus saw it, through the lens of God's presence rather than through the intensity of the storm.

Just as Jesus slept peacefully in the boat while the storm raged, believers can rest confidently in God regardless of what is happening around them.

In the day of trouble, you must have something to put your trust in.  
Trust in wealth — and it may fail.  
Trust in men — and they may disappoint.  
Trust in circumstances — and they may change.  
But when your trust is in God, you will discover that His peace is greater than every storm.

**The storm may be around you — but it does not have to be within you.**

**God's presence in your life is the guarantee of peace in the midst of every storm.**

**Amen.**